available with them. So, farmers having cash with them are in a helpless state.'[16]

- Bandu Ghormade had no choice but to accept the old ₹500 notes from the procurement agent and a lower price of ₹200 less for every 40 kg crate of his freshly harvested eggplants. 'If I didn't, my produce would have gone to waste,' said the farmer in his late 40s. He grows carrots, spinach, eggplants, and okra in Chicholi, Betuk district, Madhya Pradesh. 'Those who grow grains or cotton can hold on to their crop, I can't.' Since 8 November, Ghormade has been selling at a loss at the mandi every day, while his son is going to the nearest bank, five kilometres away, to stand in queue and deposit the notes.[17]
- Jitender Chowdhary, a farmer in Sonipat, Haryana, brings around 12 sacks of cauliflower every day to the mandi by paying the transporter ₹15 per sack. While each sack of cauliflower usually sold for anywhere between ₹200 to ₹250, it is now being sold at ₹80 or less. 'I can't do anything. If I don't sell it for this price, I will only have to feed my produce to the cattle,' said Chowdhary. In September 2016, he sowed cauliflower after getting a loan from his arhtiya (commission agent). 'I supported the prime minister's move initially but I had not imagined its fallout. The cauliflower season lasts only for a month and a half. I don't know what I will do if I don't manage to sell it now. I run the risk of doubling my loans,' said Chowdhary.
- The backbone of the fruit and vegetable mandis (wholesale markets) are the arhtiyas, who are the channel between farmers and distributors. Both the farmer and the distributor depend on the arhtiyas for logistical requirements like porters, transporters, credit accounting, etc. A successful arhtiya builds a huge network of farmers across India, and, sometimes lends money to farmers for cropping and other inputs for farming. Since the note